

MISSION STATEMENT

To assure a timely and effective system of prehospital emergency care to the victims of sudden illness and injury through a comprehensive coordinated arrangement of Health and Safety resources at a reasonable cost to the people of Solano County.

STATE EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES FRAMEWORK

- I. The framework for California Emergency Medical Services System was established within the Emergency Medical Services System and the Prehospital Emergency Medical Care Personnel Act in 1981 (See “Pertinent EMS Legislation” Policy 1400).

California State EMS Authority:

Emergency Medical Services Authority
1930 9th Street, Suite 100
Sacramento, CA 95814
(916) 322-4336

- II. Responsibilities of the State EMS Authority include:
- A. Assessing the needs of California’s EMS areas.
 - B. Coordination of EMS services within California.
 - C. Developing implementation guidelines.
 - D. Developing minimum standards for medical control policies and procedures.
 - E. Developing and promulgating regulations for minimum standards for education/training, certification, recertification, and scope of practice for prehospital emergency medical personnel.
 - F. Providing technical assistance to local EMS agencies.
 - G. Providing assistance to the State Office of Emergency Services to coordinate the EMS aspects of disaster response.

III. The EMS Commission

This multi-disciplinary commission is composed of 14 members appointed by the Governor, the Senate and the Assembly. It reviews and approves regulations, standards, and guidelines developed by the Authority. It functions primarily in an advisory capacity to the Director of the EMS Authority.

PERTINENT EMS LEGISLATION

Current laws directly affecting prehospital care are:

- The Emergency Medical Services System Act, California Health and Safety Code, Division 2.5, Section 1797 through 1799.108.

Current Regulations directly affecting prehospital care:

- California Administrative Code, Title 22, Division 9.

All emergency response units that transport patients are subject to the regulations pertaining to ambulances as stated in the Ambulance Service Handbook distributed by the California Highway Patrol.

County Resolution 81-198 (Policy 1500).



Health & Social Services Department

Donald R. Rowe, Director

Public Health Division - Mental Health - Public Guardian
Adult and Child Services - Eligibility & Employment Services
Substance Abuse Services

Public Health Division
Thomas L. Charron, M.D., M.P.H.
Health Officer/EMS Medical Director
Deputy Director, Health & Social Services

EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES
717 Missouri Street, Suite B
Fairfield, CA 94533
(707) 421-6685
FAX# (707) 421-6682

POLICY MEMORANDUM #1410

EFFECTIVE DATE: 02/01/94

APPROVED BY:

THOMAS L. CHARRON, M.D., M.P.H., SOLANO COUNTY HEALTH OFFICER/EMS MEDICAL DIRECTOR

REVIEWED BY:

ALLEN J. MORINI, D.O., ASSISTANT EMS MEDICAL DIRECTOR

AUTHORITY:

CALIFORNIA ADMINISTRATIVE CODE, TITLE 22, CHAPTER 6, SECTIONS
§100206-19927

**SUBJECT: EMS SYSTEM ORDINANCE FOR INCORPORATED AND
UNINCORPORATED AREAS OF SOLANO COUNTY**

Solano County Board of Supervisors' adopted Ordinance No. 1457 on November 24, 1992 addressing Emergency Medical Services under Chapter 7.1 of the Solano County Code. This Ordinance establishes the legal framework for the operation of an Emergency Medical Services System within Solano County.

ORDINANCE NO. 1457

AN ORDINANCE PROVIDING FOR THE
REGULATION OF EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES SYSTEM
IN THE INCORPORATED AND UNINCORPORATED
AREAS OF SOLANO COUNTY

The Board of Supervisors of the County of Solano ordains as follows:

SECTION I.

Chapter 2.7 of the Solano County Code is repealed.

SECTION II.

Chapter 7.1 of the Solano County Code entitled "Emergency Medical Services," is enacted, to read as follows:

CHAPTER 7.1

EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES

- § 7.1-10. Purpose.
- § 7.1-11. Applicability.
- § 7.1-12. Local Emergency Medical Services Agency.
- § 7.1-13. Emergency Medical Services Regulations and Requirements.
- § 7.1-14. Authority.
- § 7.1-15. Prohibitions.
- § 7.1-16. Special Exemptions.
- § 7.1-17. Emergency Medical Care Committee.

Sec. 7.1-10. Purpose.

The purpose of this chapter is to establish and provide for the implementation of provisions of the Health & Safety Code which pertain to local administration of emergency medical services, including Health & Safety Code Division 2.5, Chapter 4 (commencing with § 1797.200), and provisions of implementing regulations of the California Emergency Medical Services Authority set forth in Title 22, California Code of Regulations, commencing with § 100135. This ordinance is not intended to, nor shall it obligate any public safety agency to provide any emergency medical services outside the minimum first aid standards for public safety personnel. Should any public safety agency propose to provide any such services beyond the minimum Basic Life Support Standards, that service must adhere to Section 7.1-13 listed below.

Sec. 7.1-11. Applicability.

All references to Solano County or the County of Solano herein shall refer to the entire incorporated and unincorporated area of the County of Solano, and the provisions of this chapter apply to all such areas.

Sec. 7.1-12. Local Emergency Medical Services Agency.

The Solano County Health and Welfare Services Department is designated as the local Emergency Medical Services (EMS) agency for Solano County.

Sec. 7.1-13. Emergency Medical Services Regulations and Requirements.

The Health and Welfare Services Director (or designee) shall adopt regulations and requirements as required by California statutes and regulations providing for:

(a) Terms of written agreements between the County of Solano and cities, fire districts, and all other public safety and/or private organizations in the provision of prehospital emergency medical services.

(b) Approval and ratification by the Board of Supervisors, of an EMS system developed for Solano County meeting the requirements of applicable statutes and regulations.

(c) Terms of written agreements between the County of Solano and approved emergency medical technician--paramedic (EMT-P) service providers concerning participation in the advanced life support system and compliance with applicable State regulations and local policies and procedures.

(d) Performance standards, requirements, definitions of terms, the issuance and revocation of operating permits and the collection of fees therefor, the monitoring of Emergency Medical Services, creation and monitoring of exclusive operating zones for Emergency Medical Services ambulance providers, centralized Emergency Medical Services dispatch, imposition of civil and administrative penalties, and all other matters permitted or required by statute or regulation.

Sec. 7.1-14. Authority.

The County of Solano, by enactment of this chapter and under the authority of California statutes and implementing regulations, shall have authority to plan, regulate, and coordinate the roles and responsibilities of all emergency medical service provider agencies and organizations to insure the Solano County EMS System is providing effective and efficient care to all residents of Solano County.

Sec. 7.1-15. Prohibitions.

No person or entity shall provide emergency medical services within the incorporated or unincorporated area of Solano County

except in accordance with the provisions and requirements of this chapter and the regulations and requirements of the Director of Health and Welfare Service; provided, however, that this prohibition shall not apply to individuals who provide emergency medical services only in isolated cases, or on a non-recurring basis as described in Health & Safety Code § 1799.102.

Sec. 7.1-16. Special Exemptions.

Special exemption from the provisions of this chapter shall be made in the case of City of Vacaville or any city within Solano County which was providing prehospital emergency medical services on June 1, 1980, as required by Health & Safety Code § 1797.201. The terms of such exemption shall be determined by resolution of the Board of Supervisors.

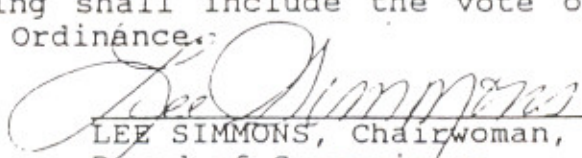
Sec. 7.1-17. Emergency Medical Care Committee.

Nothing in this chapter shall affect the roles and responsibilities of the County Emergency Medical Care Committee as provided under Health & Safety Code § 1797.270 et seq.

SECTION III.

Pursuant to provisions of Government Code Section 25124(b)(1), a Summary of this Ordinance shall be published once, at least FIVE (5) DAYS prior to the meeting of the Board of Supervisors at which the Ordinance is to be finally considered for adoption (second reading), and a summary of this Ordinance, with the vote of the members of the Board of Supervisors thereon, shall also be published once before the expiration of FIFTEEN (15) DAYS after adoption of the Ordinance. Both publications shall be in the DAILY REPUBLIC, a newspaper of general circulation, printed and published in the County of Solano, State of California, and shall be in full force and effect THIRTY (30) DAYS after its passage.

A certified copy of the full text of the proposed ordinance shall be posted in the office of the Clerk to the Board of Supervisors at least FIVE (5) DAYS prior to the meeting of the Board of Supervisors, at which the Ordinance is to be finally considered for adoption (second reading). A certified copy of the final Ordinance shall be posted in the Office of the Clerk to the Board of Supervisors, at least FIFTEEN (15) DAYS after adoption of the ordinance, and the posting shall include the vote of the Supervisors for or against the Ordinance.


LEE SIMMONS, Chairwoman,
Board of Supervisors

ATTEST:


LINDA TERRA, Clerk to the
Board of Supervisors

I, LINDA TERRA, Clerk to the Board of Supervisors of the County of Solano, State of California, do hereby certify that the above and foregoing Ordinance was introduced at a regular meeting thereof held the 10th day of November, 1992.

On the motion of Supervisor Davis and the Second of Supervisor Carroll, this Ordinance was adopted at a regular meeting of said Board on November 24, 1992, by the following vote:

AYES: SUPERVISORS Caddle, Carroll, Davis and
Chairwoman Simmons

NOES: SUPERVISORS None

ABSTAINED: SUPERVISORS None

ABSENT: SUPERVISORS Stewart

WITNESS my hand and the Seal of said Board this 24th day of November, 1992.

LINDA TERRA, Clerk to the Board
of Supervisors

By Linda Terra

RESOLUTION NO. 81-103

RESOLUTION TO ACHIEVE COMPLIANCE HEALTH
AND SAFETY CODE SECTIONS 1791.0 THRU 1799.0

WHEREAS, an Emergency Medical Service program was initiated in the County of Solano in 1976, and has been effective in reducing death and disability arising from medical emergencies and as such program is now provided for under Health and Safety Code of the State of California, Section 1797.200; and

WHEREAS, it is in the best interest of the county inhabitants to continue such program through the Emergency Medical Services program now administered by the County Department of Public Health;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED that the Solano County Department of Public Health is hereby designated the Emergency Medical Service agency for the County of Solano within the meaning of Health and Safety Code Section 1797.200; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Health Officer/Medical Director of the Solano County Department of Public Health is hereby designated Medical Health Director of said Emergency Medical Services agency within the meaning of Section 1797.202 of the Health and Safety Code of the State of California.

I, JOHN S. BLACKLOCK, Clerk of the Board of Supervisors of the County of Solano, State of California, do hereby certify that the above and foregoing Resolution was regularly introduced, passed and adopted by said Board at a regular meeting thereof held this 1st day of September, 1981.

On the motion of Supervisor NEWITT and the second of Supervisor CUNNINGHAM this Resolution was adopted by the following vote:

AYES: SUPERVISORS CUNNINGHAM, DAVIS, NEWITT AND
CHAIRMAN BLACK

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1 NOES: SUPERVISORS NONE
2 ABSTAINED SUPERVISORS NONE
3 ABSENT: SUPERVISORS BRAZELTON

4 WITNESS my hand and Seal of said Board this 2nd day
5 of September, 1981.

6 JOHN S. BLACKLOCK
7 Clerk of the Board of Supervisors

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9 By *James C. H.* Deputy Clerk
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ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

The Solano County Emergency Medical Services Agency, designated by the County Board of Supervisors as the “local EMS agency” in accordance with California Health & Safety Code, Division 2.5, is responsible to:

1. Assure the community of a safe, dependable and responsive prehospital Emergency Medical Care System and
2. Protect the County from exposure to liability in matters relating to prehospital emergency medical services within the County by:
 - A. Organize and plan for system-wide benefits,
 - B. Certify Prehospital personnel.
 - C. Approve training programs.
 - D. Approve Continuing Education.
 - E. Administer contracts with service providers.
 - F. Provide medical control.
 - G. Promulgate policies and procedures.

Solano County Health & Social Services Department



Mental Health Services
Public Health Services
Substance Abuse Services
Older & Disabled Adult Services

Eligibility Services
Employment Services
Children's Services
Administrative Services

Patrick O. Duterte, Director

EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES AGENCY

275 Beck Ave., MS 5-240
Fairfield, CA 94533
(707) 784-8155 FAX (707) 421-6682
www.solanocounty.com

Michael A. Frenn
EMS Agency Administrator

Richard C. Lotsch, D. O.
EMS Agency Medical Director

POLICY MEMORANDUM 1705

EFFECTIVE DATE: 5/11/2006

REVIEWED/APPROVED BY:

A handwritten signature in red ink, likely belonging to Richard C. Lotsch, D.O.

RICHARD C. LOTSCH, D.O.; EMS AGENCY MEDICAL DIRECTOR

A handwritten signature in red ink, likely belonging to Michael A. Frenn.

MICHAEL A. FRENN, EMS AGENCY ADMINISTRATOR

PROVIDER AGENCY MEDICAL DIRECTOR

AUTHORITY: CALIFORNIA HEALTH & SAFETY CODE, DIVISION 2.5,

I. PURPOSE/POLICY:

Each authorized provider of ALS services in Solano County is required to have a Medical Director at all times. Provider Agency Medical Directors (PAMD) are the physicians designated by and under contract with local EMS Providers licensed to provide ALS services in Solano County. The PAMD will advise and coordinate medical aspects of field care undertaken by that provider in accordance with the policies and procedures of the Solano County EMS Agency. The Solano County EMS Agency requires provider medical directors to meet the following requirements or be approved by the EMS Agency Medical Director if individuals meeting these qualifications are not available.

II. Qualifications:

- A. Board certification by the American Board of Emergency Medicine or American Osteopathic Board of Emergency Medicine.
- B. Currently engaged in the practice of emergency medicine.
- C. Attended an EMS Agency orientation.
- D. Familiar with policies, procedures and protocols of the Solano County EMS Agency.

III. Role and responsibility in prehospital care.

A. Provide program oversight by:

1. Advising the Provider Agency in planning and evaluating the delivery of prehospital medical care by EMT-Is and EMT-Ps, reviewing and approving the medical content of all EMS training performed by the provider agency and ensuring compliance with continuing education requirements of the State and Local EMS Agency Policy.
2. Reviewing the medical components of the provider agency's dispatch system.
3. Assisting in the development of procedures to optimize patient care.
4. Reviewing and recommending to the EMS Agency Medical Director any new, noninvasive medical monitoring devices under consideration and ensure compliance with State and local regulation.
5. Evaluating conformance with legal documentation requirements of patient care.
6. Participating in direct observation of field responses as needed (ride along, etc).
7. Participating with the appropriate EMS committees and the local medical community.
8. Provide DEA licensing and required ordering forms necessary to obtain and prescribe controlled substances for use by the provider agency in accordance with Solano County protocols.

B. Audit and Evaluation of patient care by:

1. Assisting the provider agency in the development and implementation of a continuous quality improvement program to ensure the provision of quality patient care.
2. Evaluating adherence of provider agency medical personnel to medical policies, procedures and protocols of the Solano County EMS Agency.
3. Coordinating delivery and evaluation of patient care with base and receiving hospitals.

C. Investigation of medical care issues by:

1. Reviewing incidents of unusual or adverse patient outcomes, inadequate performance of EMS personnel and complaints related to the delivery of medical care.
2. Evaluating medical performance, gathering appropriate facts and, when appropriate, forwarding those facts in writing to the Solano County EMS Agency Medical Director.

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EMS ADMINISTRATOR

Role and Responsibilities in Prehospital Care:

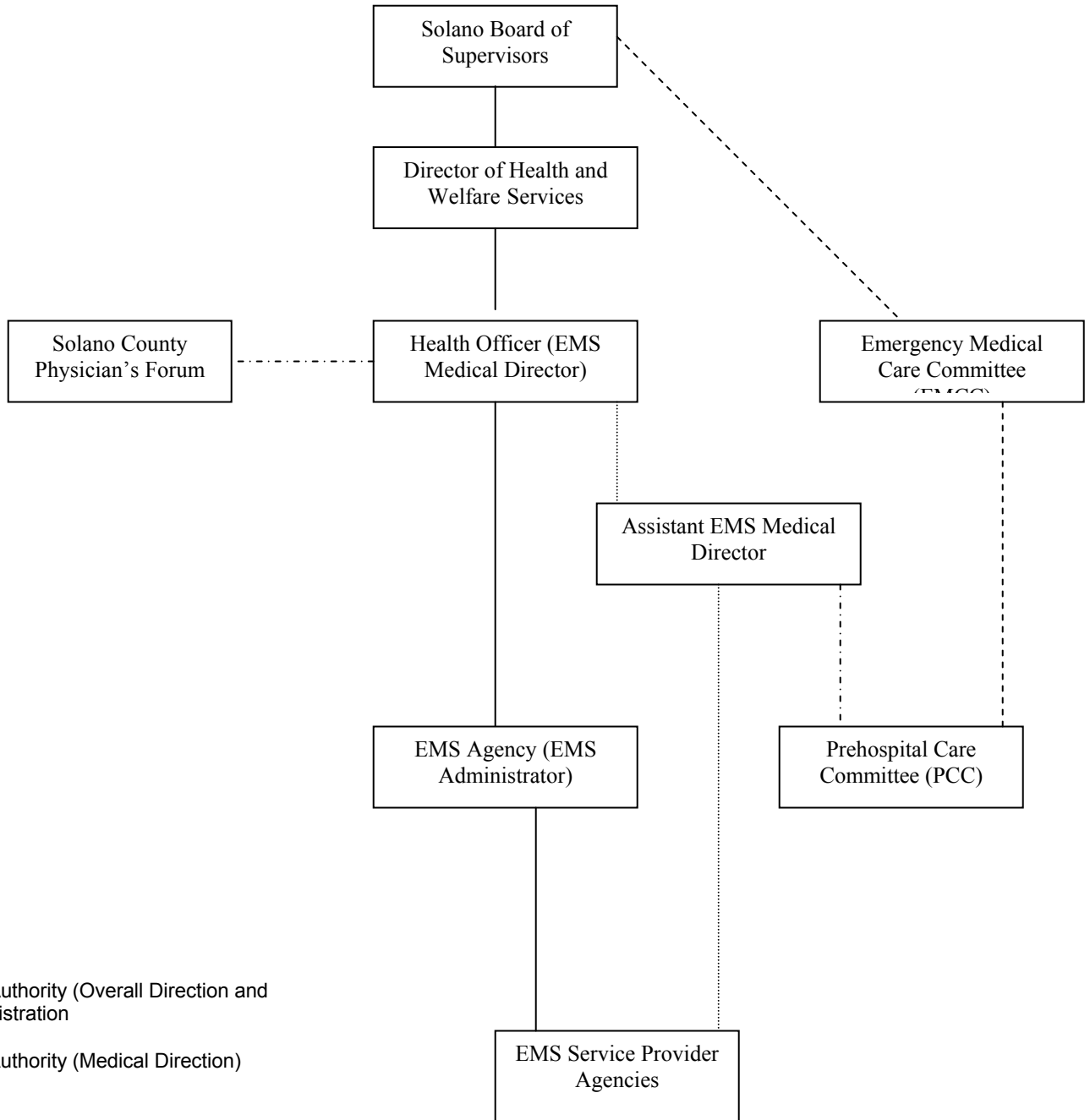
1. Insures the administrative responsibilities of the Solano County EMS Agency are being appropriately managed.
 - a. Supervise office staff.
 - b. System planning and management.
 - c. Develop and manage informational data systems.
 - d. Coordinate EMS Communications system.
 - e. Monitor and evaluate EMS system and operations.
 - f. Act as EMS Program Advocate.
 - g. Develop short and long term goals and objectives for the EMS Agency.
 - h. Budget preparation and management.
 - i. Grant application preparation.
2. Plans, implements, and evaluates Prehospital care.
3. Implements policies and procedures to ensure medical control. Implements policies and procedures relative to the operational aspects of the Prehospital care system.
4. Facilitates effective communication and cooperation as a liaison between County and EMS public safety personnel, Prehospital care providers, Base and Receiving Hospitals, and other individuals or organizations providing EMS services..
5. Oversees the investigation, evaluation and actions taken on EMS incidents.
6. Ensures that EMS service providers meet minimum standards.
7. Participates at local and State EMS levels as the representative of Solano County Emergency Medical Services Agency.
8. Administers EMS written agreements between County and EMS provider agencies.
9. Reports to the County Health Officer.

PREHOSPITAL CARE COORDINATOR

ROLE AND RESPONSIBILITIES IN PREHOSPITAL CARE:

1. Assists the Medical Director in identifying education/training needs; assists in training and orientation programs for EMS.
2. Develops and updates policies and procedures applicable to Prehospital care in conjunction with the EMS Medical Director and EMS Administrator.
3. Directs investigation, resolution and closure of complaints, Unusual Occurrences and Ambulance Dispatch failures as related to EMS.
4. Institutes disciplinary action of certified/authorized Prehospital personnel in accordance with State procedural guidelines.
5. Responsible for certification/authorization of all Prehospital personnel. Maintains and reviews records for emergency medical care personnel certified/authorized by the County Health Officer.
6. Responsible for ambulance inspection and permit issuance.
7. Plans and coordinates multi-casualty medical incident (MCI) drills and exercises with all participating agencies, participates in disaster preparedness and MCI planning activities for coordination of EMS response, assumes responsibility for revision and update of County MCI Plan and is a liaison with County Office of Emergency Services.
8. Assists Base Hospital Liaison personnel in meeting medical control responsibilities.
9. Provides liaison between EMS Office and all other agencies.
10. Participates on and provides staff support to advisory committees and subcommittees concerned with EMS.
11. Participates in the Quality Assurance Program as outlined in the Q.A. Plan.
12. Provides public information education relating to EMS as needs are identified. Assists Administration in the creation of guidelines, plans, contracts and other various documents.
13. Maintains an on-going liaison with all acute care facilities who receive EMS patients.
14. Reports to the EMS Administrator and assists in all other duties as assigned by the EMS Administrator.

**Functional Organizational Structure
EMS Policy Formation and Direction**



———— Line Authority (Overall Direction and administration)

..... Line Authority (Medical Direction)

----- Advisory (Overall EMS System)

- - - - - Advisory (Medical Direction)

EMS ADVISORY COMMITTEES

To identify the Emergency Medical Services Advisory Committees that serve the County Health Officer or his/her designee and the County EMS Agency in a professional advisory capacity.

1. Emergency Medical Care Committee (EMCC).
2. EMCC Sub-Committees.
3. Prehospital Care Committee (PCC).
4. Physician Forum.

EMERGENCY MEDICAL CARE COMMITTEE (EMCC) BYLAWS

Adopted by Solano County Board of Supervisors 2/4/92.

Revision adopted by Solano County Board of Supervisors 5/12/98.

I. NAME

The name of this organization shall be the Solano County Emergency Medical Care Committee (also referred to as the EMCC).

II. PURPOSE

The Emergency Medical Care Committee of the Solano County has been established by the Solano County Board of Supervisors by Resolution in accordance with the California Health and Safety Code Sections 1751 and 1752 as a nonprofit unincorporated association to act in an advisory capacity to the Board and the County Health Officer/EMS Medical Director on matters relating to emergency medical care.

III. DUTIES

The duties of the Emergency Medical Care Committee as specified in the California Health and Safety Code, Sections 1755 & 1756, are to at least annually:

- A. Review, at least annually, emergency medical care operating within the County, to include as per CA H&S Code 1797.274:
 - 1. Ambulance services and public safety agencies.
 - 2. Emergency medical care offered within the County, including programs for training large numbers of citizens in cardiopulmonary resuscitation and lifesaving first aid techniques.

3. First aid practices.
 4. Such related subjects assigned by the Board of Supervisors.
-
- B. Report its observations and recommendations relative to its review of the ambulance services, emergency medical care and first aid practices; the EMCC will also oversee training citizens in cardiopulmonary resuscitation, life-saving first aid techniques, as well as public participation in such programs in Solano County.
 - C. Annually, on or before the April EMCC meeting, and following Committee approval, submit observations and recommendations to the Board of Supervisors and to the Health Officer/EMS Medical Director regarding first aid, ambulance services, and any other matters relating to emergency medical care as directed by the Board of Supervisors or Health Officer/EMS Medical Director. (CA H & S Code 1979.276).

IV. COMMITTEE AGENDA

- A. EMS staff shall send an agenda and minutes of the previous meeting two weeks before the next scheduled meeting. Other meeting materials shall be distributed to members one-half (1/2) hour before the meeting for their review. The Agenda will be posted for public notice in the EMS Office.
- B. The Health Officer/EMS Medical Director or his/her designee may attach additional materials to the agenda. Committee members may contact the EMS Office and request specific materials related to an agenda item prior to the meeting. EMS staff shall attempt to comply with the committee member request. This method of information delivery is necessary to limit postage costs and wasted paper duplicating costs resulting from the large number of individuals who serve on the EMCC.

V. MEMBERSHIP

- A. General
This committee shall have a membership of individuals representing the agencies or categories as indicated on Attachment A.
- B. Approval
Annually, on or before the March EMCC meeting, the Health Officer or designee shall be responsible for contacting the various agencies or members of a membership category (excepting supervisorial district appointments) to obtain the names of individuals nominated. The names shall be submitted to the Board of Supervisors for consideration and approval.
- C. Resignations
Any member desiring to resign from the committee shall submit a resignation in writing to the Board of Supervisors, with a copy to the Chairperson of the committee. The Chair shall direct EMS Staff to initiate a process to replace the individual who resigns.

D. Alternates

Each agency or category may designate an alternate who shall attend EMCC meetings when the regular member cannot. The regular member shall inform the EMCC Chair or designee when a designated alternate will be attending in place of the member. Designated alternates shall be approved by the EMCC Chairperson to be eligible to vote in the member's absence. It is the responsibility of the approved member to keep his/her alternate and the agency/category being represented adequately informed on matters relating to the committee.

E. Attendance

It shall be the responsibility of each appointed member to attend, or assure his/her alternate attends all regular meetings of the EMCC or subcommittees to which they are appointed. Any member who has not attended, or sent the designated alternate without prior approval of the chairperson, for three consecutive regularly scheduled meetings shall be removed from membership, and his/her membership seat shall be declared vacant. The Chairperson of the EMCC shall notify the agency being represented of the vacancy and request that a replacement member be nominated to the Board of Supervisors.

VI. EXECUTIVE OFFICERS

A. General

The officers of the committee shall be a Chairperson and a Vice-Chairperson. Officers shall be elected to serve for a one year term commencing on May 1, or at the next regular meeting after May 1, and for not more than three (3) consecutive terms.

B. Duties of Officers

The Chairperson shall preside at meetings, represent the EMCC before the Board of Supervisors, coordinate the subcommittees, review and approve minutes before distribution, prepare/approve the agenda for up-coming meetings, and sign correspondence from the EMCC. The outgoing chair shall submit the required annual report for Committee and Board of Supervisors approval. The Vice-Chairperson shall assume the duties of the Chairperson in his/her absence, and shall render assistance as requested to the Chairperson.

VII. MEETINGS

A. General

All meetings of the EMCC and its subcommittees shall be open to the public. Regular meetings shall be scheduled with the time and place as determined by the membership during the regular November meeting. Should unforeseen circumstances require it, a special meeting of the EMCC may be called by the Chairperson who shall also determine time and place. Meetings shall occur at least quarterly for the purpose of conducting business.

B. Quorum

A quorum shall consist of no less than 5 voting members at any scheduled meeting.

C. Voting

All motions placed before the EMCC or its subcommittees will be approved or disapproved by a consensus of Committee. All Board of Supervisor action items and non-consensus items shall be decided by vote. Simple majority vote of the members present at quorum when the vote is taken shall decide the issue. The right of the Chairperson to vote shall be restricted to motions in which his/her vote will break a tie.

Any member who represents multiple agencies and/or categories as indicated on Attachment A shall have only one (1) vote when the committee is acting on a motion.

VIII. PARLIAMENTARY AUTHORITY

Roberts Rules of Order (Revised) shall govern all meetings of the EMCC and its subcommittees. Roberts Rules of Order may be suspended by a two-thirds vote of the voting members present at quorum.

IX. SUBCOMMITTEES

A. General

Standing or ad hoc subcommittees shall be established as deemed necessary by the EMCC. The chairperson of the EMCC shall have the option to appoint the subcommittee Chairperson. The Chairperson of the EMCC shall be an ex-officio member of all subcommittees, except the nominating subcommittee. All subcommittees shall be subject to the direction from the Chair. Activities of the subcommittee shall not conflict with the actions or direction of the EMCC or bylaws of the EMCC. Subcommittee Chairperson or their designee shall report the activities and the recommendations of the subcommittees to the EMCC for its approval and/or action.

B. Ad Hoc Subcommittees

The Chairperson and members of an ad hoc subcommittee shall be appointed by the EMCC Chairperson, after the EMCC votes to establish such a subcommittee for a specific purpose.

C. Standing Subcommittees

The Chairperson of each standing subcommittee shall be a member of the EMCC. All appointments to standing subcommittees shall serve for a period of two years from the date of appointment. Standing subcommittees shall meet at least quarterly or at the call of the subcommittee Chairperson. The purpose and function of standing subcommittees shall be reviewed by the EMCC annually. Any revisions to the stated purpose and/or function of a standing subcommittee shall be approved as an attachment to the Bylaws. Purpose and functions of standing subcommittees shall be as approved by the EMCC. Standing subcommittees may be dissolved by a majority vote if their purpose/function is deemed no longer necessary or applicable by a majority vote of the EMCC. The existing standing committees are:

1. Executive Emergency Medical Care Committee (EMCC) shall consist of Chairman, Vice Chairman, and the Board of Supervisor Representative. This committee shall meet with EMS Staff on a regular basis for consideration of EMS business when it is determined by the EMCC that the entire committee need not be present.

2. The Prehospital Care Committee (PCC) which shall consist of RNs, MICNs and EMT-1s, EMT-2 & EMT-Ps and Ex Officio EMS Staff will function under the PCC bylaws. This committee shall meet with EMS Staff on a regular basis for consideration of EMS issues that deal with the technical aspects of EMS care. The PCC shall report its recommendations to the EMCC.

X. AMENDMENT OF BYLAWS

Bylaws of the EMCC may be amended by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of all members present at the next EMCC meeting following the 30 day notice. Notice of proposed changes shall be sent to all members thirty days in advance. Membership and duties of the EMCC shall remain the prerogative of the Board of Supervisors, as governed by the California Health and Safety Code, Sections 1751 and 1756.

APPENDIX A

VOTING MEMBERSHIP OF EMCC

	# of Votes
Consumer Representative	1
Incorporated Cities of Solano County	7
Benicia	
Dixon	
Fairfield	
Rio Vista	
Suisun City	
Vacaville	
Vallejo	
ALS Providers	6
Medic Ambulance	
AMR Ambulance	
REACH Helicopter	
CALSTAR Helicopter	
UCD LifeFLight	
CHP Air Operations	
Base Hospitals	2
Sutter-Solano Medical Center	
North Bay Medical Center	
CHP Area Operations	1
PCC Chairperson	1
EMT Training	1
Paramedic Training	1
Office of Emergency Services (OES)	1
Fire Chief's Association/Rural Fire Districts	1
Members at Large	5
TOTAL	27

EMS Staff and affiliated County Staff in attendance are non-voting members of the Committee. Staff shall attend for recording of minutes, dissemination of reports, and clarification of technical details of EMS program or policies as requested by the Committee.

It is a goal of The EMCC to encourage and allow a large cross-section of the community to have input into the development of the Solano County EMS System.

It is recognized that multiple membership seats of different organizations could be assigned to the same individual, to allow for dissemination of EMCC activities and information to various organizations that are affected by the Solano EMS System. Individuals representing more than one organization/agency shall have only one vote.

Solano County Health & Social Services Department

Mental Health Services
Public Health Services
Substance Abuse Services
Older & Disabled Adult Services



Patrick O. Duterte, Director

Eligibility Services
Employment Services
Children's Services
Administrative Services

Public Health Division
Thomas L. Charron, M.D., M.P.H.
Health Officer/EMS Medical Director
Deputy Director, Health & Social Services

EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES AGENCY
Michael A. Frenn, Agency Administrator
275 Beck Avenue MS 5-240
Fairfield, Ca. 94533
(707) 784-8155 FAX (707) 421-6682

POLICY MEMORANDUM #1790

May 2003

EMS PHYSICIANS' FORUM

APPROVED BY:

A handwritten signature in dark ink, reading "Thomas L. Charron MD".

THOMAS L. CHARRON, M.D., M.P.H., SOLANO COUNTY HEALTH OFFICER, EMS MEDICAL DIRECTOR

SOLANO COUNTY EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES (EMS) EMS PHYSICIANS' FORUM

- I. Authority – The Medical Director of the EMS Agency is mandated to assure medical control and quality assurance by State regulation (Health & Safety Code 1797.220). The EMS Medical Director may appoint one or more physicians to assist in this function (Health & Safety Code 1797.202(b)). The EMS Physician Forum Committee is formally designed by the EMS Medical Director to perform this task.
- II. Mission – The mission of the EMS Physician Forum is to review and evaluate the safety, adequacy, appropriateness, and effectiveness of the emergency medical care provided to citizens of Solano County in order to maintain or improve the quality of care. The findings of the forum shall be reported directly to the EMS Medical Director and Solano County Health Officer.
- III. Objectives – the Medical Quality Assurance Plan. Objectives are to preserve and enhance the high quality of patient care in Solano County by ensuring among other things that:
 - A. Patient care services are appropriately organized with clear channels of supervision, responsibility and accountability;
 - B. Patient care appropriate to the needs of the patients is delivered in a timely manner, is optimal within the range of available resources, is consistent with achievable goals and is properly documented;
 - C. Patient care is delivered in as cost-effective a manner as possible;

- D. All elements entering into the care of emergency patients will be subject to periodic review, either retrospective or concurrent, with the use of pre-established objective criteria and documentation of findings; and
- E. The findings of patient care review are utilized by the EMS Medical Director in concrete ways to assure that citizens in Solano County receive optimal emergency medical care.

IV. Scope and Coverage of the Medical Quality Assurance Plan

- A. Services Covered: Services that have a bearing on the care of patients entering the EMS system will be included in the Quality Assurance Program. Such services and groups include but are not limited to the following:
 - 1. Prehospital EMS system;
 - 2. Patients who died either in the Prehospital system and/or upon arrival at a hospital emergency department.
 - 3. Emergency interfacility transfers originating in Solano County hospitals using the EMS system as the transport medium;
 - 4. Any patient complications resulting from EMS patient care.
 - 5. Performance review of Solano authorized EMS Providers.
- B. Responsibility – It is the responsibility of the Physician Forum to establish, maintain and support through representatives of each participating hospital and/or ALS field provider, an ongoing Quality Assurance Review that includes effective mechanisms for reviewing and evaluation of prehospital emergency care and that provides for effective responses to the findings of such evaluation. The following activities will be incorporated in the Medical Quality Assurance Plan:
 - 1. Identification of potential problems or concerns in the delivery of health care services;
 - 2. Objective assessment of the cause and scope of each problem;
 - 3. Implementation of decisions and plans designed to resolve observed problems;
 - 4. Monitoring activities designed to ensure that the desired results have been achieved;
 - 5. Documentation substantiating the effectiveness of the program in improving patient care and ensuring sound clinical performance.
- C. Principal Activities:

1. System Review

A Medical Quality Assurance Program can be implemented through the performing of a variety of analytical studies of the nature and quality of care services and the manner of their delivery. Patient care evaluation studies may be either retrospective or concurrent. Where possible, such studies will be focused upon potential enhancement of care or established problems in the delivery of services.

- a. Data sources may include:
 - i. Patient Care Report Forms
 - ii. Death Audits
 - iii. Medical Control Audits
 - iv. ALS without Base Contact forms
 - v. EMS Office Unusual Occurrence Reports
 - vi. Coroner's Findings
 - vii. Individual Emergency Department Patient Medical Records

2. Policy Development

- a. All policies dealing with patient care shall be reviewed by Physician's Forum for a recommendation to the EMS Agency Medical Director.
- b. Physician's Forum shall review all policies dealing with operations and administration for the purpose of providing comments.

3. Protocol Development

- a. Physicians' Forum shall review all field treatment protocols and shall make recommendation to the EMS Agency Medical Director prior to their implementation.

4. Medical Quality Improvement Standards

- a. Physicians' Forum shall set the standard for Medical Quality Improvement processes in Solano County.
- b. Physicians' Forum shall provide direction to, and receive information from the Continuous Quality Improvement (CQI) Committee. This may include:
 - i. Directing focused audits.
 - ii. Development of CQI standards
 - iii. Development of CQI Coordinator performance standards
 - iv. Development of CQI policies and procedures

5. Studies

Studies may be addressed to problems arising in connection with a diagnosis, a procedure, a treatment modality or the operation of a

department or service. Identification of suitable topics may be based upon evidence of problems revealed through previous studies or information received from the CQI Committee, as well as upon the observations and insights of members of the various professional staffs and services.

V. Organization, Duties, and Meeting of the Physician Forum

A. Membership

1. Chair – EMS Medical Director
2. Base Hospital Physician Liaison from each Base Hospital
 - a. Sutter-Solano Medical Center
 - b. North Bay Medical Center
3. Emergency Department Medical Director (or Designee) from the following receiving hospitals:
 - a. Kaiser
 - b. David Grant Medical Center
4. ALS Provider Medical Directors
 - a. Medic Ambulance Service, Inc.
 - b. Vacaville Fire Department
 - c. Benicia Fire Department
 - d. Cordelia Fire Protection District
 - e. Dixon Fire Department
 - f. Fairfield Fire Department
 - g. Rio Vista Fire Department
 - h. Vallejo Fire Department
 - i. Physicians serving multiple organizations (i.e., hospitals and/or ALS Providers) shall have only one vote).
5. EMS Staff as follows (ex-officio)
 - a. Assistant EMS Medical Director
 - b. EMS Administrator
 - c. Prehospital Coordinator
 - d. Base Hospital Liaison Nurses

B. Lines of Authority

The Chair shall report to the EMS Medical Director/Solano County Health Officer, if applicable. The Health Officer shall report to the Board and EMCC when appropriate.

C. Confidentiality of Committee Proceedings

The meetings and proceedings of Physician Forum and any subcommittees shall be confidential and in accord with Section 1157.7 of the Evidence Code, State of California. All Physician Forum records will be stored in a locked administrative

file at the EMS Office; each physician member shall maintain a similar system at their respective hospital.

D. Meetings of the Physicians' Forum

- a. Meetings of the Physicians' Forum will be held in accordance with the schedule published by the EMS Agency. The Agency will publish the schedule, as approved by Physician's Forum, no later than December 15 for each following calendar year.
- b. Physicians' Forum is not an elected body and is therefore not governed by the meeting requirements of the Brown Act.
- c. At each meeting, MD Forum shall review a report from the CQI Committee, plus any Unusual Occurrence, or any other relevant issue as identified by the EMS Agency staff or any member of Physicians' Forum. If at the end of a case review it is determined that a problem exists and follow-up is deemed necessary, the committee chair may elect to perform any of the following:
 1. If the problem is an EMS system issue, the chair may request the Assistant EMS Medical Director or EMS staff to resolve the issue and report back to the committee.
 2. If the problem is associated with a hospital, the chair may request a committee member associated with the hospital to resolve the issue and report back to the committee.
 3. The Chair may directly elect to follow and resolve the issue.
 4. ALS provider specific issues will be referred to the ALS Provider Medical Director for review and follow-up. The Provider Medical Director will report findings and/or action back to Physicians' Forum as deemed necessary by the committee.
 5. If applicable, an identified issue may be referred or submitted to the Board, EMCC, PCC or other appropriate agency or organization for further action.

E. Selection Of Member To The SEMSC Board

MD Forum shall, at a time of vacancy, select a physician member to serve as the Physician Representative on the Solano EMS Cooperative (SEMC) Board of Directors. This appointment shall be made in accordance with the terms and conditions of the SEMSC by-laws.

VI. Annual Review of Physician Forum Activities

The Physician Forum will review its medical retrospective review process at least once per fiscal year to assess its effectiveness and to consider possible changes. When the Physicians' Forum decides that changes are needed, they will submit the recommended

changes to the EMS Medical Director/Health Officer. When consensus is reached with the Health Officer and Forum members agree, the changes will be made.
